Nadi v1.3 Guide

SATTVAGENIC · ANDREW JEPSON

Nadi turns any sound into a set of tuned resonators — chakras — that ring, pulse and sing in a raga. Feed it something short and plucky, pick a preset, and shape it from there. Right-click almost anything for more.

Install and activate

1. **Run the installer** for your system. It puts Nadi in the standard plug-in folders: VST3 on Mac and Windows, and AU on Mac.
2. **Open your DAW** and rescan plug-ins if Nadi doesn't appear.
3. **Try it for 30 days.** The trial is the full plugin. After it ends, Nadi keeps working but drops out for 3 seconds in every 45 until it's activated.
4. **Activate** from the menu (the icon at the top right) > **Activation...**. Enter the email and licence key from your Gumroad receipt. It needs the internet once; after that Nadi stays activated offline.

Quick start

Six moves get you from an empty insert to something alive.

1. **Put Nadi on a track** that already has sound on it: a pluck, a drum loop, a drone.
2. **Set the Source** on the yantra rim (bottom right): **P** percussive, **M** melodic, **D** drone. It sets the safety limits and the style Inspire rolls in.
3. **Load a preset**, or click the yantra centre to **Inspire** a fresh sound. Click it again until something speaks to you.
4. **Turn Mix** to taste. Nadi is a resonator, so it usually sits best somewhere short of fully wet.
5. **Right-click anything.** Dials, faders, phrases, Offset and Mutate all hide their extra options there.
6. **Undo** (bottom bar, and the arrow at the top) steps back through your last 32 Inspires, Mutates, presets and material or note changes. Right-click it to redo, or to jump several steps at once.

Hover over a control for a one-line explanation. Tooltips can be switched off in the settings menu.

Your first patch

This workflow takes a plain pluck to a moving, two-phrase pattern in about ten minutes. It suits percussive and melodic sources.

1. **Make a small plucky sound** in a synth or sampler and play it on every 16th note. Short and dry works best: Nadi supplies the ring.
2. **Add Nadi** after it.
3. **Choose a Starter preset.** Starters use only a few chakras, so there's room to build.

4. **Try each Nadi** (Ida, Pingala, Sushumna, Balanced, under the raga). Each changes the materials and the way the Shakti moves.
5. **Set Resonance, Sympathy and Sustain** to taste. Resonance is how long and strongly the chakras ring, Sympathy how many hear the source at once, and Sustain plucked (left) to lush (right).
6. **Add one chakra.** Click a dark seal (the dot left of a chakra's name) to unmute it, then click the row to open it in the inspector. Change its material and note to taste.
7. **Move its level.** Right-click its VOL fader and choose **LFO 1 > Deep (±50%)**.
8. **Try different sync divisions.** With **Sync** on, click the division beside it and step through 1/16, 1/8, 1/8T and so on.
9. **Find the groove.** Once a division feels right, drag **Offset** until the pattern sits best against the bar.
10. **Let the groove breathe.** Right-click Offset and choose **LFO 2 > Gentle (±10%)**.
11. **Write a second phrase.** Click **B**, then change one chakra's note. Click **ORDER**, choose **AB**, and set **Next phrase** to **Each bar**.

To finish: right-click **Mutate** and tick **Lock Melody**. Now click Mutate a few times. It nudges the sound while keeping your two phrases intact. Undo if a nudge goes too far.

The face

The left half is the instrument: the Shakti, the seven chakras and the inspector. The right half is the sound: presets, tuning, dials and the yantra.



Area	Where	What it does
Shakti	Top left	**Sync** locks the sweep to the host; the division beside it sets its speed (Rise times the whole climb, Step the gap between chakras). **Bandha** keeps the sweep between the lowest and highest sounding chakras. **Offset** slides the pattern against the bar. **A–D** are four phrases (melodies); **ORDER** sets how they follow one another. The count at the top right is japa: her rounds as beads on a 108-bead mala, with a counter bead lit for each mala completed.
Chakra strip	Left, middle	One row per chakra, Muladhara at the bottom. **VOL / PAN / DEC** switch what the faders set; **1 2 3** turn them into Aux sends. Click the seal (the coloured dot by the name) to mute or unmute it; it goes dark when muted. Click the S at the end of the row to solo it. Click the note box to change the note, and anywhere else on the row to open it in the inspector.
Inspector	Lower left	The chosen chakra (arrows step between them). **Earthly / Subtle** picks the material bank, then the material. Its **note** and **octave** (mandra, madhya, taar). **Aroha / Avaroha** set whether it sounds as the Shakti rises, falls, or both. **BODY** shapes the material: Tone, Bend, Shift, Stretch, Odd/even. Shift-drag a body dial to set every chakra.
Presets	Top right	Browse by category, or step with the arrows.
Tuning	Right, upper	**Sa** is the tonic (shift-drag snaps to semitones; click the Hz to type it). **Raga** is the scale, with each raga's time and mood in the menu. **Ida, Pingala, Sushumna, Balanced** are the four Nadis.
Tabs	Right, middle	**Sadhana**: how the chakras ring and the Shakti moves (Resonance, Sympathy, Harmony, Drive, Feedback, Sustain, Attack, Drift, Ananda, Rate, Input, Mix). **Akasha**: space and the mix (Definition, Spatial, Tail width, Duck, Mask, Prana, HP and LP cut, Chords, Output). **Motion**: the two LFOs.
Bottom bar	Bottom right	**Limiter**, **Auto gain**, **MIDI In** (play Sa from MIDI notes) and **Glide**. The **yantra**: Source on the rim, Inspire in the centre. **Mutate** and **Undo** below it.



The chakra strip, Vyapini muted: its seal and name go dark. The S at the end of a row solos it.

Recipes

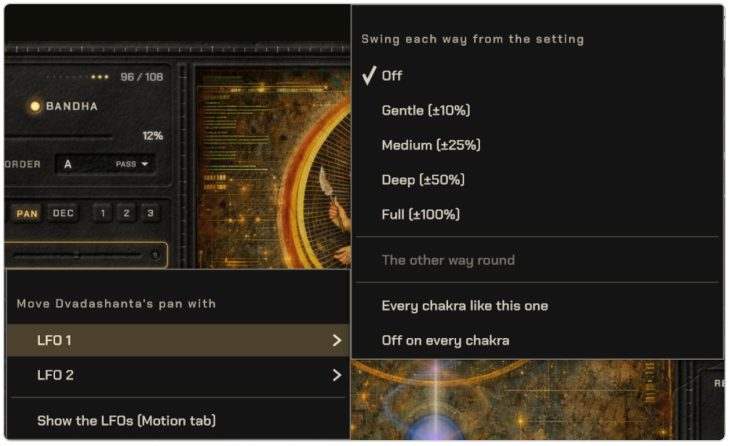
Short answers to "how do I...". Each one stands alone.

Make it move

Right-click a dial or fader, choose **LFO 1** or **LFO 2**, and pick how far it swings each way from the dial's setting: Gentle (±10%), Medium (±25%), Deep (±50%) or Full (±100%) of the whole dial. A dial set near one end has less room that way, so its swing stops at the end. **The other way round** flips the direction. On a chakra fader, **Every chakra like this one** copies the movement to all seven.



An LFO's reach shows as an arc around the dial, with a bead where the sound has it now.



The LFO menu on a chakra fader.

Shape the LFOs on the **Motion** tab. **Shape** is Sine, Triangle, Wander (drifts somewhere new each cycle) or Steps (jumps). **Rate** is in seconds; click the small dot left of RATE to sync it to bars instead. **Spread** makes the movement travel up the spine, each chakra a little later. **Amount** scales everything that LFO moves.

Shape a chakra's body

Every material is built from partials: the separate tones that together make one sound. The five **BODY** dials under the inspector reshape them for the selected chakra. Shift-drag any of them to set every chakra at once.



Anahata in the inspector. The Bend label reads MEEND, its mode.

- **Tone** tilts the partials darker or brighter.
- **Bend** moves the pitch as each note sounds. It has three modes (next recipe).
- **Shift** moves every partial by the same number of hertz, so they fall out of tune with each other. A little adds a metallic edge.
- **Stretch** spreads the partials wider apart or squeezes them closer.
- **Odd/even** lifts the odd harmonics and cuts the even, or the other way round, changing the hollowness of the tone.

Slides and swings: Meend and Andolan

In Indian classical music, *meend* is a glide from one note into the next, and *andolan* a slow swing on a single note. Nadi can do both, and a gamak: a single shaped pull on one note. Click the **BEND** label (or right-click the dial) to choose the mode; the label changes to show it.

- **Strike**: each strike starts a few semitones away and settles. The dial sets how far.
- **Meend**: each note slides in from the note heard before it. The dial sets how much of a step the slide takes. Leaps wider than Pa (the fifth note of the scale) lean in from two semitones rather than gliding all the way.
- **Andolan**: the note swings away and back, in time with the Shakti. Minus swings below, plus above. Right-click for **Andolan speed**: half, one, two or four swings per step.
- **Gamak**: once per strike, the note dips a little, rises slowly to the dial's amount and sighs back down, like a sitar's pull in Todi. Right-click for **Gamak length**: 0.6, 1.2 or 2.4 seconds, or in time (1/8, 1/4, 1/2 or a bar).

Every chakra like this one, in the same menu, copies the mode to all seven.

Some ragas have their own andolan on particular notes. Open the **Raga** menu and tick **Andolan as the raga sings it**. The menu lists which notes swing in the current raga, or says there are none.

Write a melody

Each phrase, **A** to **D**, gives every chakra a note. Click a letter to edit it: the note boxes and the inspector's NOTE now show that phrase. Right-click a letter to copy another phrase into it, or clear it.



Phrase B being edited under ORDER AABA, with an Offset mark at 25% and the japa count at the top right.

Click **ORDER** to choose a pattern (AB, AABA, ABCD and so on, or type your own) and when to move on: each pass of the Shakti, each bar, or every 2 or 4 bars.

Shift the groove

With Sync on, **Offset** slides the pattern against the bar: same notes, different accents. On Step divisions it moves in whole steps.

Right-click Offset to **mark** a sweet spot; the thumb then snaps to it. Right-click a mark to remove it. Marks are saved with the preset.

To morph between grooves, right-click Offset and give it an LFO. A small depth drifts the pattern gently. With the LFO set to **Steps** and two or more marks, it walks from mark to mark and back.

Keep what you like

Right-click **Mutate** or the **yantra** for the locks: Materials, Body and Motion apply to both. Each has its own Raga lock (Mutate's is on from the start, Inspire's off; lock Inspire's to keep a host tuning file right), and Mutate also has Melody. A small padlock shows on the yantra and on Mutate while anything is locked; hover it to see what's kept.



The yantra: click the centre to Inspire, a letter on the rim to set the Source. The padlocks show what's locked.

Inspire rolls a whole new sound in the Source's style. Mutate makes small changes to the current one. About one Inspire in six goes leftfield. When ORDER plays B, C or D, Inspire writes each as a variation of the new A, so AABA lets you hear more of a roll.

Send a chakra to reverb

Click **1**, **2** or **3** above the faders: they now send each chakra to Nadi's Aux 1, 2 or 3 output. Raise a chakra's fader to send it. Small amounts go a long way.

In your DAW, make a new audio track and set its input to Nadi's Aux output (in Live: **Audio From** > Nadi > Aux 1, Monitor **In**). Put the reverb or delay on that track.

Right-click an Aux fader for set levels, and **Every chakra like this one** to copy its send and LFO to all seven. Aux faders take LFOs too.

Tame one resonance

Right-click the Aux fader and switch it from **Send** to **Out**. Now that chakra leaves the main output and plays only on the Aux, at its fader's level. Put an EQ, compressor or resonance suppressor on that track to treat it alone.

> **Soloing with Out.** Ananda's chord (and Grace's) always plays on Nadi's main output, and as it opens it turns the chakras down. With chakras sent Out to an Aux, soloing only Nadi's own track lets you hear the chord but not those chakras, so when Ananda comes down the sound seems to vanish. Nothing is wrong: the chakras are back on the Aux tracks you aren't hearing. Solo the Aux tracks along with Nadi's (in Live, Ctrl-click or Cmd-click each Solo button).

Tanpura shimmer

Click the small **Open** dot beside Sympathy. Every chakra now hears the source all the time, like a sitar's sympathetic strings, and the Shakti lifts the ones she passes. Low Sympathy gives an even ring of every chakra; high Sympathy a shimmer rolling through them. Best on drones.

Chords

Turn up **Ananda** to open a chord over the chakras. Its small jewel turns on **Grace**, where chords bloom by themselves now and then. The padlock beside its value is the chord lock, which keeps the last chord for every chord after. **Chords** on the Akasha tab sets their level. For a chord that swells at the end of every 4 or 8 bars, leave Ananda at 0, right-click it, give it an LFO set in time to 4 or 8 bars on Sine, and choose The other way round.

Play it from MIDI

Turn on **MIDI In** and Sa follows the notes you play; the whole raga moves with it. **Glide** sets how Sa slides between notes. MIDI In also switches the Limiter on, since fast notes over a low Sa build quickly.

Concepts

Five ideas explain nearly everything on the face.

- **Chakras** are seven tuned resonators, Muladhara at the base to Dvadashanta at the crown. Each has a note in the raga and a material that gives it its voice.
- **The Shakti** is the energy that climbs and falls through the chakras, striking each as she passes. Sync, the division and Offset set her rhythm. **Sympathy** sets how far she reaches, so how many chakras ring at once.
- **Sa and the raga.** Sa is the tonic; the raga is the scale every chakra is tuned from. Change Sa and everything moves together.
- **The four Nadis** set the character. **Ida** is cool and lunar, **Pingala** warm and solar, **Balanced** is Ida rising and Pingala falling. All three use the earthly materials. **Sushumna**, the central channel, uses the subtle materials and adds *taraf*: every chakra rings softly with the others.

- **Materials** come in two banks of 14. **Earthly** are real instruments: stone, ghatam, bells, a singing bowl, strings, bamboo, tuned skins and drums. **Subtle** are imagined ones: volcanic glass, resin, crystal strings, light, singing water. Any chakra can use either bank.

About Nadi

Nadi grew out of the *Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra*, a Kashmiri text of 112 ways into stillness. Several of them work through sound: listening to a stringed instrument until only the listening remains, or following a chanted syllable as it fades into silence. Nadi's ringing chakras, the Shakti climbing between them and the sympathetic strings of Sushumna are a picture of that idea in sound.

It is part of Sattvagenic's wider work: bringing old yogic psycho-technology together with modern tools and art.

Nadi as a practice aid

- **Chant with it.** Put Nadi on your microphone's track with monitoring on. Turn **Sa** until its note name matches the note you chant on (a tuner app will tell you), and the chakras ring in harmony with your voice. Keep Mix low, so the voice stays at the centre.
- **Count with the japa.** Each round of the Shakti is a bead, and 108 make a mala. A counter bead lights for each mala completed. Let a drone such as Om or Tambura Shimmer run, and use the count as you would a mala.
- **Sit or move with it.** A slow drone through a long reverb (Sahasrara Bath, Tambura Shimmer, Long Breath) makes a quiet companion for meditation or yoga.

A note on tradition

Nadi takes its inspiration from tantric teaching on the subtle body and from Indian classical raga. It doesn't claim to represent either faithfully. The chakras, the Nadis and the Shakti are used as a creative map, not as instruction. Nadi's ragas are each raga's notes and mood, without the rules of movement, ornament and time of day that make a raga what it is in a musician's hands. For the real thing, seek out a teacher, the texts and the music itself.